Limit Raises

Print Page Download PDF

6.5k Shares

Email Share Post

Limit Raises are used after partner opens the bidding with 1-of-a-suit. A jump raise (e.g. 1♥:3♥ or 1♣:3♣) shows 10-12 points and 4-card support. 5-card support is possible opposite a minor-suit opening. Opener can pass a limit raise with minimum values, or bid on with more.

Back in the old, old days, this sequence showed a strong game-forcing hand. Over time, players gradually realized that this approach was too uncommon and impractical. Hence the birth of the limit raise.

There is expert debate about 3-card limit raises opposite a 1♥/♠ opening bid. When playing 5-card majors, some partnerships make limit raises with 3-card support and unbalanced shape.

Examples

Opener	Responder
♠AQ987	♠KJ43
♥T92	♥A4
♦Q5	♦984
♣A98	♣Q632

Opener	Responder
1♠	3♠ (1)
Pass (2)	

1. Limit raise
2. Passing with a minimum

Opener	Responder
♠6	♠KJ5
♥KQT84	♥A973
♦AK98	♦3
♣Q43	♣J9762

Opener	Responder
1♥	3♥ (1)
4♥ (2)	

1. Limit raise
2. Bidding game with sufficient values

Opener	Responder
♠65	♠AJ9
♥A873	♥KT52
♦AJ6	♦QT853
♣AJ42	♣3

Opener	Responder
1♦	1♥ (1)
2♥	3♥
4♥	

1. Showing a 4-card major has priority over a minor-suit limit raise

In Competition

Limit raises are typically off in competition. Jump raises become preemptive, showing 0-6 points and 4-card support (possibly 5-card support in response to a minor). With this approach, responder can then show a limit raise or better by either:

- using the Jordan 2NT convention over an enemy takeout double, or
- making a a cue-bid after an enemy overcall

Other Considerations

Preemptive jump raises have become a common alternative in uncontested auctions. Inverted minors constitute a method of showing weak 4+ card support for partner's minor suit openings, while Bergen raises are the equivalent for the majors.

See also

- Bergen Raises
  A method of raising 1♥/♠ opening bids that includes weak jump raises.
- Inverted Minors
  A method of raising 1♣/♦ opening bids in which a single raise is strong and a double raise is weak.
- Jacoby 2NT
  A 2NT response to 1♥/♠ showing game-forcing support
- Jordan 2NT
  An artificial 2NT raise after an opposing takeout double. Promises limit raise strength or better.
- Reversed Splinters
  A variation of splinters in which the bid suit shows shortness in another suit.
- Splinters
  A double-jump shift to show unbalanced, game-forcing support in response to a major suit.